



Participant Information Pack

EVENT DETAILS AND WHAT TO
EXPECT FOR SYNCs HACK 2026



powered by





WELCOME

SYNCS HACK 2026 OUTLINE

You will have 24 hours to create a working prototype. This can be anything from a website, a software application, to a game, a system or hardware solutions. We strongly recommend you to do some brainstorming now before the hackathon starts so you come in with ideas.

We also encourage you to join our [SYNCS HACK workshop](#) this Friday where we will introduce the version control system Git (all SYNCS HACK submissions require your git repo link), how to use Devpost to submit your project, talk about what is a hackathon and tips on how to win.

WHAT'S IN THIS GUIDE

- Checklist (MUST DO)
- Event Details
 - Location, schedule, signing in
- Submission Details
- Judging Details
 - Marking criteria, judging process
- Prizes
- FAQ
- Code of Conduct

CHECKLIST

WHAT TO DO BEFORE HACKING

Join the SYNCs Discord & SYNCsHACK Channel*

Find a team + Register your team

Register on Devpost and join SYNCs HACK 2026

WHAT TO BRING

Laptop + Phone

Chargers + power cables

Cutlery + crockeries (**MANDATORY**)

Deodorant

Water bottle / cup

Toiletries **

Blanket / Sleeping Bag**

Any hardware your team wants to use***

* Please follow the instructions in 'Announcements' for joining SYNCsHACK channel

** Optional, if you plan on staying overnight

*** No soldering at the event

EVENT DETAILS

LOCATION

- Institute Lecture Theatre N295:
For the opening ceremony.
- J12 School of Computer Science
Building: For hacking, mentoring, food
and judging

The first floor of the computer science building will be open for the duration of the hackathon. You are encouraged to participate in this event in-person and welcome to stay overnight, or come and go as you please.

SCHEDULE: SATURDAY

9:30 - 10:45	Sign In
	Group Formation
10:30 - 10:45	Move to Opening Ceremony
11:00 - 12:00	Opening Ceremony
12:00	Hacking Begins!
13:00 - 14:00	Lunch (CSB)
14:00 - 18:00	Mentoring sessions
6:00 - 7:00	Dinner (CSB)

SCHEDULE: SUNDAY

9:00 - 9:30	Breakfast (CSB)
12:00	Hacking Ends!
12:30 - 13:30	Lunch (CSB)
12:00 - 14:00	Preliminary Judging - 3 min video submissions
14:30 - 16:15	Final Judging - 4 min live pitch + Q&A
	Judges Final Discussion
16:30 - 17:00	Award Ceremony

SIGN IN



- Please sign in to the event at the **Winter Garden, J12 Computer Science Building.**
- For late sign in after 10:45AM, please come to **Boardroom 124** in the **J12 Computer Science Building.**
- Please note if you **do NOT have a group**, you must arrive at least **30min before** the opening ceremony to be assigned a group later.
- SYNCS HACK Merch is only for ticket-holders who's ticket includes Merch.
- Sponsorship Merch (Separate to SYNCS Merch) will be given out via first come, first serve.

SUBMISSION DETAILS

SUBMISSION

SUBMITTING ON DEVPOST:

We will be using DevPost for project submissions. Please register an account on DevPost and join our hackathon on [this page](#) before you start hacking.

Judges will have access to your Devpost submission, so make sure to write a clear description of your project.

You need to submit your project by 12:00PM AEST on Sunday Aug 30th for it to be considered for judging. We strongly encourage you to create your DevPost submission on the Saturday and edit it throughout the event so that you don't have to rush to submit on the Sunday morning.

**SUBMIT BY 12:00PM
SUNDAY, 30TH
AUGUST**

**LATE SUBMISSIONS WILL
NOT BE ACCEPTED.**

THINGS YOU SHOULD INCLUDE:

- Link to your Git repository (compulsory).
 - Version history to be maintained.
- What problem are you trying to solve?
- Who would use it?
- What is your prototype?
- How does your prototype work?
- How did you implement your prototype?
- Link to your working prototype.

WHAT TO SUBMIT AND JUDGING

3 MIN VIDEO DEMO

The preliminary judging will be based on a **maximum 3 minute video demonstration** of your project. The judging criteria (see next page) is the same as the final judging. Make sure to clearly demonstrate what your prototype can do and how it works.

PRESENTATION

The final judging will be a **live pitch style presentation** to our panel of judges. Only the top **10-12 teams** will progress to this round. The duration of this presentation is limited to a **maximum of 4 minutes**. We encourage you to accompany your pitch with presentation slides, although this is not compulsory. How you pitch your project to the judges is completely up to you.

JUDGING CRITERIA

LEVEL OF INNOVATION

- Is the idea original? Are there existing/similar solutions to your problem in the real world?
- Is your solution unique and creative?

PRACTICALITY OF SOLUTION

- Is your solution useful in the real world? What value will the solution bring?
- Who would use your solution?

TECHNICAL COMPLEXITY

- Does your solution demonstrate a strong level of personal technical ability?
- Is the solution impressive?
- Were there any technical challenges during your dev that were expertly handled?

ELEGANCE OF SOLUTION

- Is the user experience smooth?
- Is the design intuitive?
- Is your program functional and robust?

JUDGING PROCESS

AFTER HACKING CONCLUDES

Preliminary Judging

- Max 3 min video demonstration

Final Judging

- Max 4 min live presentation
- 2-3 min Q&A with the judges

After judges have determined the winners in each of the prize categories (listed on the next page), winning teams will be announced at the award ceremony. **This will be held at J12 Lecture Theatre 123 at 4:30pm on Sunday, Aug 30.**

PRIZES

1ST PLACE

\$2,500

2ND PLACE

\$1,500

3RD PLACE

\$1,000

Theses main prizes will be judged using the criteria on the previous page

CITADEL BEST TECH

- Is the feature itself innovative?
- Is the feature implemented well in the app?
- How complex is this new feature?



Logitech G512 CARBON LIGHTSYNC RGB
Mechanical Gaming Keyboard (GX Brown
Switch)

BEST UI/UX PRIZE

- Is the design user friendly?
- Is the UI aesthetic and eye catching?
- Does the design accomodate for a range of user levels?



Q201 SOUNDCORE I HYBRID ACTIVE NOISE
CANCELLING HEADPHONES

BEST PITCH

- Is the pitch flawlessly engaging?
- Is the pitch presented in an exceptionally effective and organised manner?
- Does the pitch clearly convey to the judges what the desired functionality is and what the expected behaviour is?



Anker 325 Power Bank
(PowerCore 20K)

OTHER PRIZES

The People's Choice Prize will be chosen by all the SYNCs HACK 2026 participants, and the Best First Year Team Prize will be chosen by the SYNCs executives team via preliminary judging.

PEOPLE'S CHOICE

- Based on SYNCs HACK 2026 participants' votes
- Must have at least a working prototype and demo video



Logitech G305
Lightspeed Wireless
Gaming Mouse (White)

BEST FIRST YEAR TEAM

- Over 50% of the team must be first year students
- Judged with the same criteria as main prizes



Soundcore Select 4 Go
Bluetooth Speaker

BEST MEME PRIZE

A Surprise :P

- Join the [SYNCs HACK 2026 Discord](#)
- Submit your best content at # 🧐 | memes
- Emoji uploads and reactions encouraged

FAQ

How many team members can my team have?

Teams can have 1-5 team members. We can help you find a team on the day if you don't already have one.

Do I own the rights to anything I develop at the hackathon?

Yes, absolutely! SYNCs does not own anything you develop at our hackathon.

Can I start developing my project before the hackathon?

No, you can't, but you are welcome to bring ideas with you. We will be verifying your project and may disqualify teams that don't comply with this.

Can I use existing frameworks and libraries for my project?

Absolutely! If you are building off existing tools (game engines such as Unity) or using large-scale frameworks (React) they should be mentioned in your project description on your team's Devpost page so we can judge the projects appropriately. If you are building things from scratch, make sure to let the judges know so they can mark with this in mind.

Do I have to stay overnight?

Not at all! You are welcome to go home overnight and come back in the morning. If you do decide to stay overnight, there is a shower in the building.

CODE OF CONDUCT

By participating in SYNCs HACK 2026 you agree to abide by the Hack Code of Conduct. You can view it [here](#).

CONTACTS

SYNCs ORGANISERS

Jeffrey Liang: 0420480205

Tamara Parsons: 0424269509

Alex Mao: 0404688868

Tim Wang: 0402283659

Edmond Wong: 0499907772

EMERGENCY CONTACTS

- Police, Ambulance, Fire Brigade (24 hour) - 000
- State Emergency Service (24 hour) - 132 500
- Nurse On Call (24 hour) - 1300 606 024
- Lifeline (24 hour) - 1 114
- New South Wales Poisons Information Centre - 13 11 26
- Sexual Assault Crisis Line (24 hour) - 1800 806 292
- SuicideLine (24 hour) - 1300 651 251